

Queens of the Castle

Duration:

Core concept: search algorithms, co-ordinates.

Complexity: Low Medium High

Preparation: Low Medium High

Space requirements: if possible, a large open floor space where a giant chessboard can be created.

Goal of game

- Students try to place n queens on a chessboard without any of them attacking each other. They work up to the 8 queens problem.
- Once they have found a solution in their workbooks, they will test it on a human sized chessboard!

Preparation & materials

- On the day, you will need to set up a giant chess board. Decide ahead of time how you want to do this (options are given in the lead setup doc)
- If you have many tutors, you may use them as queens on the giant board - alternatively, you can make crowns out of paper to place as giant pieces.
- Many of the resources have several options. Decide which materials best suit your space.

Tips & notes

- You may want to modify your version of the lead instructions - currently they include several options for how to set up the giant grid/run the game. Adjust your copy to just include what is relevant for your setup/equipment.

Directory

In this folder you will find:

Resource list  Resource List - TEMPLATE	Spreadsheet that details what materials need to be printed and/or sourced to run the game. Calculates approx. amounts needed according to number of expected students. NOTE: many of the resources have several options. Decide which materials best suit your space.
Lead instructions  Lead Setup	Detailed overview of how the game should be run, how the space should be set up etc. <i>This doc is for whoever will be running the game on the day.</i>
Tutor instructions + answers  Tutor Solutions	Instructions for tutors with answers and tips.
Slides  Slides	Slides to be presented

Printable materials	All the documents needed to run the game e.g. student worksheets, instructions, posters etc. See the resource list for details.